PIZZOCCHERI ALLA VALTELLINESE

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**1 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Buckwheat dough
432 g	Yukon gold potatoes, peeled and diced into ½-inch pieces
28 g	Olive oil
165 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
5 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
1 kg	Savoy cabbage, cored and cut into 3- to 4-inch strips
120 g	Fontina, coarsely grated and at room temperature
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated

METHOD

1. Cut 454 g of pizzoccheri from the buckwheat dough.
2. Boil a small pot of heavily salted water. Cook the potatoes 3 to 5 minutes, until tender but still with a little bite. Drain and set them aside.
3. Set a large saute pan or Dutch oven over medium-low heat with the oil and 30 g of the butter. Add half the garlic and cook it 10 to 15 seconds, until it smells, with no color at all.
4. Tip in the cabbage and cook 3 to 5 minutes, until wilted and tender. Take the pan off the heat.
5. Put a large pot of water on to boil over high heat and salt it heavily.
6. In a small saucepan over medium-low heat, cook the remaining butter with the remaining garlic 3 to 4 minutes, to a foaming golden brown. Set it aside somewhere warm.
7. Cook the pizzoccheri 3 to 5 minutes, until tender without going soft.
8. Set the cabbage pan back over low heat. Lift the pasta across with a spider, add the potatoes and turn everything together gently.
9. Spread half the pasta, cabbage and potato in an even layer in a 9 by 13-inch casserole dish.
10. Scatter half the fontina and half the parmigiano over, then spoon half the warm garlic butter across the cheese.
11. Build a second layer the same way, with the rest of the pasta and cheese and the last of the garlic butter.
12. Take the casserole dish to the table and serve family style.

NOTES

Bitto is the traditional cheese and is hard to find outside the Valtellina. Good Fontina Val d'Aosta is the stand-in.
Grate the fontina ahead and let it come to room temperature, so it melts the moment the hot pasta lands on it.
Do not toss the finished dish. The two layers of cheese and garlic butter are meant to melt down through the pasta as it sits.
The traditional method boils the potatoes and cabbage first and then cooks the pasta in the same water. This version cooks the cabbage in oil and butter instead and uses separate pots.
Buckwheat was grown in the Valtellina for centuries before this dish was recorded in the eighteenth century, because it is hardy and its growing season is short.

DOUGH

Buckwheat Dough

Makes: 715 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

300 g	Tipo 00 flour
75 g	Buckwheat flour
340 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading

METHOD

1. Stir the 00 and buckwheat flours together in a bowl until the colour is even throughout.
2. Tip the mixture onto a wooden surface and bank it into a wall around a well 5 to 6 inches across, no wider. Too much space and the wall will not hold the yolks once you start drawing flour in.

3. Mix the yolks, but do not beat them. Beaten yolks run and are harder to contain.
4. Pour half the yolks into the well. With a fork, pull flour down from the inner face of the wall, working round the circumference in one continuous direction.
5. Add the rest in the same way, taking in flour as you go. If the wall gives way, catch the escape with a bench scraper and fold it back in at each edge until the mass is thick enough to hold itself.
6. Knead 8 to 10 minutes. Press down and away with the heel of your hand, using your weight rather than your arm, hold the near edge with the other hand, then rotate 180 degrees, fold and press again. The dough starts sticky, so keep returning what clings to your hands.
7. Scrape clumps off the board as you work. Dust with flour only if you must, since extra flour dries it out.
8. Stop when it is smooth and firm and springs back slightly when poked. Play-Doh is the texture to aim for.
9. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes, which is what makes it pliable enough to roll.

NOTES

340 g of yolks is roughly 18 to 20 eggs, so decide what the whites are for before you start.
Buckwheat carries no gluten, so the 300 g of 00 is doing all the structural work. The ratio is not something to shift.
Chilled overnight is fine. Pull it out 20 minutes ahead so it comes back to room temperature before rolling.
Use within 24 hours.
This is the dough for pizzoccheri.

SHAPE

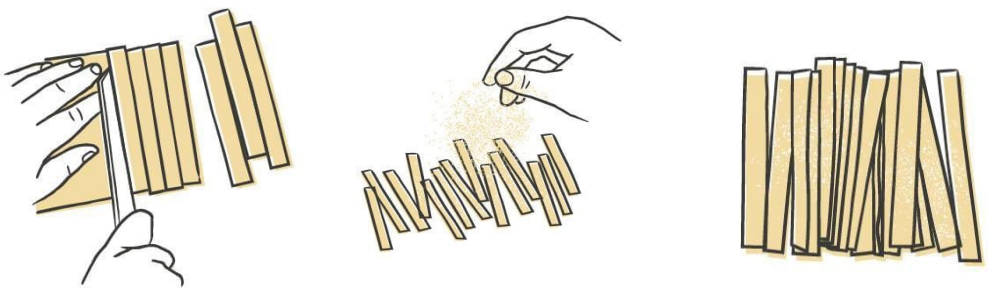
Pizzoccheri

Region: The Valtellina, in Lombardy / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make the buckwheat dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 18 by 4 1/2-inch rectangles and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet down with the long side nearest you. Cut 1/2-inch strands, working inward from one edge.
5. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour, shake them apart, and spread them in a single layer on the pan.
6. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
8. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3

NOTES

This shape needs buckwheat dough, which is not one of the four standard doughs in this collection.
The protective consortium's ratio is one part 00 flour to four parts buckwheat. Robbins reverses it, so 00 flour dominates, and uses egg yolk in place of water. The result is less gritty and more pliable.
Cut width is 1/2 inch. Sheets get cut to 18 by 4 1/2 inches first.
Spread the cut strands in a single layer rather than nesting or coiling them.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
The dish it belongs to is pizzoccheri alla valtellinese, built on cheese, potatoes, butter, and cabbage. It also suits other hearty, vegetable-forward pastas.